

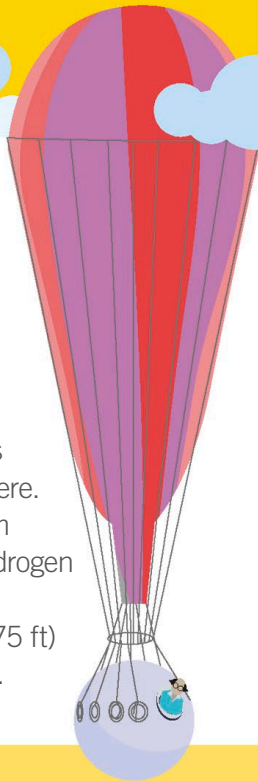
May

27

1931

High-flier

Swiss physicist Auguste Piccard and assistant Paul Kipfer set a record for the highest flight and became the first humans to enter Earth's stratosphere. Travelling in an aluminium capsule attached to a hydrogen balloon, they reached a dizzying 15,781 m (51,775 ft) over Augsburg, Germany.



1937

Golden Gate Bridge

After four years of construction, the Golden Gate Bridge – the world's longest suspension bridge at the time – opened in San Francisco, USA, with a special pedestrian day. About 200,000 people joined the celebrations on the bridge before vehicles began crossing the next day.



Born this day

1837 Wild Bill Hickok, legendary gunfighter and folk hero in America's Wild West. He built his reputation by telling false or exaggerated tales about his exploits.

Battle of Tsushima

In this epic naval battle, fought in the waters off Japan during the Russo–Japanese War, Japanese forces almost wiped out the Russian fleet.

1905



Also on this day

1941 An attack by British battleships sank the gigantic German vessel *Bismarck* in the Atlantic Ocean off France.

1963 **Jomo Kenyatta** was announced as the first prime minister of Kenya. Thousands took to the streets of Kenya's capital Nairobi to celebrate.

1997 The first entirely female polar expedition arrived at the North Pole, having travelled from Ward Hunt Island in Canada by skis and sledges.